MILLIONAIRE'S CHOCOLATE CARAMEL TART

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
1 tart at 23 cm or 6 to 8 tartlets at 10 cm, 8 to 12 servings	**40 min**	**2 h for the caramel to set, then 2 h for the chocolate**	**about 5 h, not counting the shell**

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Chocolate buckwheat tart dough, baked and cooled
160 ml	Heavy cream, for the caramel
2 tbsp	Water, for the caramel
85 ml	Corn syrup, for the caramel
150 g	Sugar, for the caramel
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold, for the caramel
1 tsp	Flaky sea salt, such as Maldon
180 g	Bittersweet chocolate, in chunks, for the ganache
225 ml	Heavy cream, for the ganache
2 tbsp	Corn syrup, for the ganache
2 tbsp	Unsalted butter, at room temperature, for the ganache

METHOD

1. Make the chocolate buckwheat tart dough, line a 23 cm tart pan or six to eight 10 cm tartlet pans, bake the shells through and cool them. See the dough.
2. Stand the cooled shell on a baking sheet, ready to fill.
3. For the caramel, put the 160 ml of cream in a small heavy pan over medium heat and take it to just short of a boil. Turn the burner to its lowest setting and hold it there warm.
4. Put the water, the 85 ml of corn syrup and the sugar in a medium heavy pan. Bring it to a boil over medium heat, swirling the pan gently until no sugar grain is left.
5. Now leave it alone, no stirring, 7 to 8 minutes, until the syrup is a deep amber. Once the color starts to come it will scorch in seconds, so stay with the pan.
6. Off the heat, drop in half the cold butter and swirl it through, then pour the warm cream in slowly. Expect it to boil up hard.
7. Wait for the bubbling to drop back, whisk the caramel smooth, then whisk in the rest of the butter.
8. Return the pan to medium-low heat and keep the caramel at a gentle boil for 30 seconds to thicken it. Take it off the heat.
9. Pour the caramel into the shell and give it about 2 hours to cool and set.
10. Scatter the flaky salt evenly across the surface of the caramel.
11. For the ganache, bring 5 cm of water to a bare simmer in a medium pan over medium-low heat.
12. Pick a medium heatproof bowl that sits firmly on the pan rim and melt the chocolate in it, held clear of the water, stirring it smooth with a rubber spatula. Lift the bowl off.
13. Bring the 225 ml of cream and the remaining 2 tbsp of corn syrup to a simmer in a small pan over medium heat.
14. Pour the hot cream onto the chocolate and stir gently with the spatula, working as little air in as you can, until the ganache is smooth. Stir the soft butter through.
15. Pour the ganache over the salted caramel. Turn, tilt and tap the pan as needed to settle it into an even layer.
16. Leave the tart at room temperature about 2 hours, until the chocolate has set.
17. Cut with a knife warmed in hot water and wiped dry before every cut, and serve the tart at room temperature.

NOTES

Take the caramel to a properly dark amber. A pale caramel has not cooked the sweetness out of the sugar and the finished tart turns cloying.
The caramel's 60 g of butter goes in cold and in two halves, one before the cream and one after. The ganache butter is a separate 2 tbsp and wants to be soft.
The caramel gets its full 2 hours of setting before the salt and the ganache go on.
Keeps wrapped at room temperature up to 3 days.
The same quantities fill six to eight 10 cm tartlet shells. A 23 cm tart is rich enough to cut into slivers.
The caramel's corn syrup is printed as both 1/4 cup and 85 ml, which cannot both be right, since a quarter cup is 60 ml. Corn syrup is dense enough that a quarter cup weighs about 85 g, so the second figure is almost certainly a weight printed under a volume heading. Weigh out 85 g and the two agree.

DOUGH

Chocolate Buckwheat Tart Dough

Makes: 1 tart shell, 23 cm, or 4 tartlet shells at 10 cm / Active Time: 20 min / Rest: 1 h chilled minimum or overnight, then 15 min once lined / Total Time: about 2 h / Oven: 325F / 160C, 13 to 15 min partially baked, 12 to 15 min longer for fully baked

INGREDIENTS

175 g	Einkorn flour
45 g	Buckwheat flour
30 g	Almond flour
2 tbsp	Cocoa powder
140 g	Unsalted butter, at room temperature
85 g	Confectioners' sugar, sifted
1	Egg, large
1	Egg white, large, beaten

METHOD

1. Sift the three flours and the cocoa powder together into a small bowl and set it aside.
2. Paddle the butter and confectioners' sugar in a stand mixer on low until smooth, then stop and scrape the bowl down with a rubber spatula.
3. Raise the speed to medium-low and beat in the whole egg. Scrape the bowl down again.
4. Back on low, add the dry mixture and run the mixer only until it disappears into the dough.
5. Turn the dough onto a lightly floured bench and knead it gently to take up any dry patches the mixer missed.
6. Flatten it into a disk 12 mm thick, wrap it tightly and chill at least 1 hour, or overnight.
7. To line a pan, roll the disk out to 3 mm on a lightly floured surface, working from the middle outward in every direction. Lift the sheet and swing it a quarter turn every few passes, dusting flour underneath when it grabs, and keep moving so the dough stays cool.
8. Cut a circle 5 cm wider than the pan.
9. While the dough is still cool, lay the circle in the pan, settle it into the bottom and up the sides, and press it home gently. Do not pull it to fit, because stretched sides shrink back in the oven.
10. If the dough has softened too far to handle, chill it a few minutes before transferring it.
11. Patch any tear with a scrap, pressing firmly so it holds. With a sharp knife, trim the edge flush with the rim of the pan.
12. Put the lined shell in the fridge or freezer until firm, about 15 minutes.
13. For tartlets, roll the dough the same way, cut circles to suit your pans and line them. Freeze whatever is left, scraps included.
14. Heat the oven to 325F. Prick the base all over with fork tines or a knife tip, tiny holes about 5 cm apart.
15. Bake a large shell 13 to 15 minutes for partially baked, or tartlet shells 8 to 10 minutes. The pastry should look dry and matte with only a little color. Turn the pans during the bake if one side is running ahead.
16. A minute or two short of the color you want, pull the shell out and brush the base and sides thinly with the beaten egg white. Return it until the color arrives and the white has set.
17. For a fully baked shell, carry on as above but give it 12 to 15 minutes more, to golden brown.
18. Cool the shells completely on wire racks.

NOTES

No salt in this dough at all, and the cocoa powder is given by volume with no weight alongside it.
One hour of chilling is enough here, where the flaky and sweet doughs both want two.
A batch lines one 23 cm shell and no more, so scale it if you need a pair.
The egg white brushed inside the shell seals the pastry against a wet filling, the same job the egg wash does on sweet tart dough.
Golden brown is the stated cue for a fully baked shell, but cocoa makes color hard to judge. Lean on the 12 to 15 extra minutes and a base that feels dry and firm.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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